

HOUSE No. 4015**The Commonwealth of Massachusetts**

PRESENTED BY:

Shirley B. Arriaga

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act promoting housing stability for older adults across the Commonwealth.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Shirley B. Arriaga</i>	<i>8th Hampden</i>	<i>1/8/2025</i>
<i>Thomas M. Stanley</i>	<i>9th Middlesex</i>	<i>3/13/2025</i>
<i>Erika Uyterhoeven</i>	<i>27th Middlesex</i>	<i>3/20/2025</i>
<i>Susannah M. Whipps</i>	<i>2nd Franklin</i>	<i>4/1/2025</i>
<i>Samantha Montaño</i>	<i>15th Suffolk</i>	<i>4/14/2025</i>
<i>Homar Gómez</i>	<i>2nd Hampshire</i>	<i>4/14/2025</i>
<i>James C. Arena-DeRosa</i>	<i>8th Middlesex</i>	<i>4/14/2025</i>
<i>Michelle M. DuBois</i>	<i>10th Plymouth</i>	<i>4/14/2025</i>
<i>Aaron L. Saunders</i>	<i>7th Hampden</i>	<i>4/15/2025</i>
<i>Bud L. Williams</i>	<i>11th Hampden</i>	<i>4/16/2025</i>
<i>Russell E. Holmes</i>	<i>6th Suffolk</i>	<i>5/8/2025</i>
<i>Tara T. Hong</i>	<i>18th Middlesex</i>	<i>5/15/2025</i>
<i>Mike Connolly</i>	<i>26th Middlesex</i>	<i>5/14/2025</i>
<i>Natalie M. Higgins</i>	<i>4th Worcester</i>	<i>5/21/2025</i>
<i>Lindsay N. Sabadosa</i>	<i>1st Hampshire</i>	<i>6/13/2025</i>
<i>David Allen Robertson</i>	<i>19th Middlesex</i>	<i>8/1/2025</i>
<i>Chynah Tyler</i>	<i>7th Suffolk</i>	<i>8/15/2025</i>
<i>James K. Hawkins</i>	<i>2nd Bristol</i>	<i>10/8/2025</i>

<i>Carmine Lawrence Gentile</i>	<i>13th Middlesex</i>	<i>10/8/2025</i>
<i>Patricia D. Jehlen</i>	<i>Second Middlesex</i>	<i>10/15/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 4015

By Representative Arriaga of Chicopee, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 4015) of Shirley B. Arriaga and others relative to expanding a short-term housing bridge pilot program. Housing.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act promoting housing stability for older adults across the Commonwealth.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. The secretary of housing and livable communities shall convene a steering
2 committee relative to expanding a short-term housing bridge pilot program, established in item
3 7004-0107 of section 2 of chapter 140 of the acts of 2024, to facilitate interim housing stability
4 for individuals statewide applying for more affordable permanent housing situations. Eligibility
5 for the expanded pilot program shall include households with individuals who: (i) are 60 years of
6 age or older; (ii) reside in the commonwealth; (iii) are otherwise eligible for housing under items
7 7004-0107, 7004-9005 or 7004-9024 of section 2 of chapter 140 of the acts of 2024; (iv) have
8 incomes of not more than 80 per cent of the area median income; and (v) are at risk of eviction
9 due to their inability to consistently pay rent; provided, that households participating in the pilot
10 program shall not, while receiving such assistance, be required to pay more than 30 per cent of
11 their monthly adjusted income for rent, mortgage or other housing financial obligations. The
12 steering committee shall consist of the following members: the secretary of housing and livable
13 communities, or a designee, who shall serve as chair; a representative of the executive office of

14 aging and independence; a representative of the Massachusetts Coalition for the Homeless, Inc.;
15 a representative of each of the participating aging services access points, established pursuant to
16 section 4B of chapter 19A of the General Laws; a representative of the Home Care Alliance of
17 Massachusetts, Inc.; 3 older adults who have experienced housing instability or homelessness, to
18 be nominated by the Massachusetts Coalition for the Homeless, Inc.; the house and senate chairs
19 of the joint committee on elder affairs; the house and senate chairs of the joint committee on
20 housing; 1 additional member of the senate to be appointed by the president of the senate; 1
21 additional member of the house of representatives to be appointed by the speaker of the house;
22 and other members as deemed appropriate by the secretary. The committee shall coordinate and
23 advise the agencies toward establishing and expanding a short-term housing bridge pilot program
24 to facilitate interim housing stability for households with individuals 60 years of age or older
25 residing in the pilot program's designated service areas. Annually, not later than December 31,
26 the committee shall file a report with the governor, the house and senate committees on ways and
27 means, the joint committee on elder affairs and the joint committee on housing. The report shall
28 be posted simultaneously on the website of the executive office of housing and livable
29 communities. The report shall include, but not be limited to, the committee's recommendations
30 on implementing the program statewide.

31 SECTION 2. Subject to appropriation or third-party reimbursement, the executive office
32 of housing and livable communities shall enter into performance-based contracts with designated
33 older adult serving agencies to establish and expand a short-term housing bridge subsidy
34 program for adults 60 years of age or older who are experiencing housing instability or
35 homelessness in urban, suburban and rural areas of the commonwealth, informed by the
36 recommendations of the steering committee established in section 1.